

INDIA-AFRICA DEVELOPMENT AND DIGITAL PARTNERSHIP

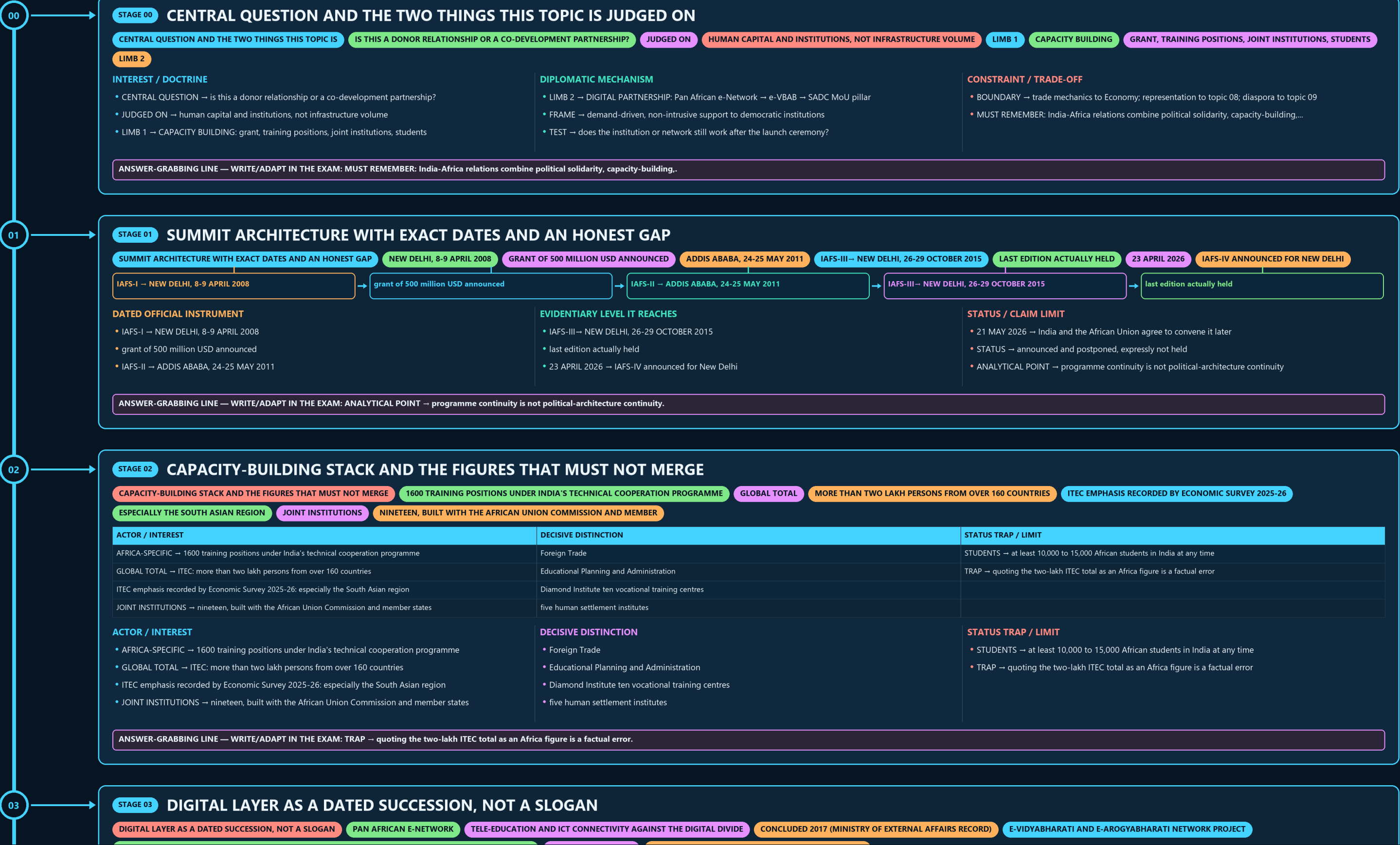
CENTRAL QUESTION AND THE → SUMMIT ARCHITECTURE WITH EXACT → CAPACITY-BUILDING STACK AND THE → DIGITAL LAYER AS A → THE CURRENT DATED INSTRUMENT → THREE GAPS THAT SEPARATE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



03

AFRICA-SPECIFIC → 1600 training positions under India's technical cooperation programme

GLOBAL TOTAL → ITEC: more than two lakh persons from over 160 countries

ITEC emphasis recorded by Economic Survey 2025-26: especially the South Asian region

JOINT INSTITUTIONS → nineteen, built with the African Union Commission and member states

Foreign Trade

Educational Planning and Administration

Diamond Institute ten vocational training centres

five human settlement institutes

STUDENTS → at least 10,000 to 15,000 African students in India at any time

TRAP → quoting the two-lakh ITEC total as an Africa figure is a factual error

ACTOR / INTEREST

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

• AFRICA-SPECIFIC → 1600 training positions under India's technical cooperation programme

• GLOBAL TOTAL → ITEC: more than two lakh persons from over 160 countries

• ITEC emphasis recorded by Economic Survey 2025-26: especially the South Asian region

• JOINT INSTITUTIONS → nineteen, built with the African Union Commission and member states

• Foreign Trade

• Educational Planning and Administration

• Diamond Institute ten vocational training centres

• five human settlement institutes

• STUDENTS → at least 10,000 to 15,000 African students in India at any time

• TRAP → quoting the two-lakh ITEC total as an Africa figure is a factual error

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → quoting the two-lakh ITEC total as an Africa figure is a factual error.

04

DIGITAL LAYER AS A DATED SUCCESSION, NOT A SLOGAN

PAN AFRICAN E-NETWORK

TELE-EDUCATION AND ICT CONNECTIVITY AGAINST THE DIGITAL DIVIDE

CONCLUDED 2017 (MINISTRY OF EXTERNAL AFFAIRS RECORD)

E-VIDYABHARATI AND E-AROGYABHARATI NETWORK PROJECT

THE NAMED SUCCESSOR IMPLEMENTATION AGREEMENT WITH TELECOMMUNICATIONS CONSULTANTS INDIA

MEA APRIL 2026 BRIEF

22 AFRICAN COUNTRIES; 15,116 SCHOLARSHIPS OFFERED

PAN AFRICAN e-NETWORK → tele-education and ICT connectivity against the digital divide

CONCLUDED 2017 (Ministry of External Affairs record)

e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project: the named successor implementation agreement with Telecommunications Consultants India Limited

project launched 2019

MEA April 2026 brief: 22 African countries; 15,116 scholarships offered

DATED OFFICIAL INSTRUMENT

EVIDENTIARY LEVEL IT REACHES

STATUS / CLAIM LIMIT

• PAN AFRICAN e-NETWORK → tele-education and ICT connectivity against the digital divide

• CONCLUDED 2017 (Ministry of External Affairs record)

• e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project: the named successor implementation agreement with Telecommunications Consultants India Limited, signed 10 September

• project launched 2019

• MEA April 2026 brief: 22 African countries; 15,116 scholarships offered

• LIMIT → scholarships offered is an input measure, not completion or employment

• LIMIT → no continent-wide digital public infrastructure rollout is established

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → no continent-wide digital public infrastructure rollout is established.

05

THE CURRENT DATED INSTRUMENT FOR THE DIGITAL PILLAR

2 JULY 2024, SADC SECRETARIAT

INDIA-SADC MOU ON ECONOMIC COOPERATION SIGNED BY

SADC EXECUTIVE SECRETARY ELIAS MPEDI MAGOSI AND INDIA'S HIGH

BOTSWANA AND SPECIAL REPRESENTATIVE TO SADC, BHARATH KUMAR KUTHATI

THE EARLIER INDIA-SADC ECONOMIC-COOPERATION MEMORANDUM OF 14 OCTOBER 1997

FRAMED AGAINST

SADC'S RISDP 2020-2030 AND ITS DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION STRATEGY

ACTOR / INTEREST

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

2 JULY 2024, SADC SECRETARIAT → India-SADC MoU on Economic Cooperation signed by

SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to

Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati

RENEWS → the earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997

human and social development

new and emerging technologies (ICT development, connectivity, access, digital public infrastructure)

space cooperation

green growth

research and innovation

STATUS → statement of intent; entry into force and delivery need separate verification

ACTOR / INTEREST

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

• 2 JULY 2024, SADC SECRETARIAT → India-SADC MoU on Economic Cooperation signed by

• SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to

• Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati

• RENEWS → the earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997

• FRAMED AGAINST → SADC's RISDP 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy

• human and social development

• new and emerging technologies (ICT development, connectivity, access, digital public infrastructure)

• trade and investment

• disaster risk management

• women-led development

• space cooperation

• green growth

• research and innovation

• STATUS → statement of intent; entry into force and delivery need separate verification

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: STATUS → statement of intent; entry into force and delivery need separate verification.

THREE GAPS THAT SEPARATE ANNOUNCEMENT FROM DELIVERY

DELIVERY QUESTION

CORRECT WORDING

500 MILLION USD GRANT

WAS IT DISBURSED?

ANNOUNCED COMMITMENT

190+ LOCs, USD 10 BN

WERE FUNDS DRAWN AND SPENT?

COMMITMENT

DELIVERY QUESTION

CORRECT WORDING

500 million USD grant

was it disbursed?

announced commitment

190+ LoCs, USD 10 bn

were funds drawn and spent?

extended to 41 countries

19 joint institutions

staffed and functioning?

being established jointly

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05

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STAGE 05

THREE GAPS THAT SEPARATE ANNOUNCEMENT FROM DELIVERY

THREE GAPS THAT SEPARATE ANNOUNCEMENT FROM DELIVERY

DELIVERY QUESTION

CORRECT WORDING

500 MILLION USD GRANT

WAS IT DISBURSED?

ANNOUNCED COMMITMENT

190+ LOCs, USD 10 BN

WERE FUNDS DRAWN AND SPENT?

COMMITMENT	DELIVERY QUESTION	CORRECT WORDING
500 million USD grant	was it disbursed?	announced commitment
190+ LoCs, USD 10 bn	were funds drawn and spent?	extended to 41 countries
19 joint institutions	staffed and functioning?	being established jointly
15,116 scholarships	were they completed?	offered, in 22 countries

ACTOR / INTEREST

• DELIVERY QUESTION

• CORRECT WORDING

• 500 million USD grant

• was it disbursed?

• announced commitment

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

• were funds drawn and spent?

• extended to 41 countries

• 19 joint institutions

• staffed and functioning?

• being established jointly

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

• were they completed?

• offered, in 22 countries

• RULE → name the gap explicitly; the marks sit in the distinction, not the number

• TRADE BOUNDARY → USD 81.99 billion in FY2024-25 is scale context, owned by Economy

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: STATUS → statement of intent; entry into force and delivery need separate verification.

06

→

STAGE 06

CO-DEVELOPMENT AGAINST DONOR CONDITIONALITY

CO-DEVELOPMENT AGAINST DONOR CONDITIONALITY

IS INDIA SIMPLY ANOTHER EXTERNAL DONOR WITH A TEMPLATE?

INSTITUTIONS BUILT JOINTLY WITH THE AFRICAN UNION COMMISSION AND

DOES SUPPORT CARRY POLITICAL CONDITIONALITY?

NON-INTRUSIVE SUPPORT TO THE DEVELOPMENT OF DEMOCRATIC INSTITUTIONS

DOES NON-INTRUSIVE MEAN INDIA IS POLITICALLY ABSENT?

NO, IT MEANS ENGAGEMENT WITHOUT CONDITIONALITY OR PRESCRIPTIVENESS

OPEN QUESTION

INTEREST / DOCTRINE	DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM	CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF
• PROBLEM → is India simply another external donor with a template? • RESPONSE: institutions built jointly with the African Union Commission and members • PROBLEM → does support carry political conditionality?	• RESPONSE: non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions • PROBLEM → does non-intrusive mean India is politically absent? • RESPONSE: no, it means engagement without conditionality or prescriptiveness	• OPEN QUESTION → uniform realisation needs country-specific dated evidence

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OPEN QUESTION → uniform realisation needs country-specific dated evidence.

07

→

STAGE 07

THE MAINTENANCE TEST AS THE REAL MEASURE OF LONG-TERM

THE MAINTENANCE TEST AS THE REAL MEASURE OF LONG-TERM

SUMMIT PLEDGE, MEMORANDUM SIGNATURE OR LAUNCH CEREMONY

CONSTRUCTION OR ENROLMENT

THE VISIBLE FIRST-YEAR OUTPUT

STAFFING, FUNDING AND TECHNICAL SUPPORT AFTER THE LAUNCH

CONTINUED USE BY THE PARTNER INSTITUTION AND ITS OWN

ONLY THE LAST TWO STEPS EVIDENCE A LONG-TERM INSTITUTIONAL

ANSWER-WRITING MUST CITE CONTINUITY, NOT THE SIZE OF THE

ANNOUNCEMENT → summit pledge, memorandum signature or launch ceremony

CONSTRUCTION or ENROLMENT: the visible first-year output

STAFFING, FUNDING and TECHNICAL SUPPORT after the launch

CONTINUED USE by the partner institution and its own students or patients

VERDICT → only the last two steps evidence a long-term institutional partnership

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

• ANNOUNCEMENT → summit pledge, memorandum signature or launch ceremony

• CONSTRUCTION or ENROLMENT: the visible first-year output

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

• STAFFING, FUNDING and TECHNICAL SUPPORT after the launch

• CONTINUED USE by the partner institution and its own students or patients

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

• VERDICT → only the last two steps evidence a long-term institutional partnership

• CONSEQUENCE → answer-writing must cite continuity, not the size of the pledge

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → only the last two steps evidence a long-term institutional partnership.

08

→

STAGE 08

SECURITY I IMR WITH ITS EXACT I LIMITS

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07

STAGE 07

THE MAINTENANCE TEST AS THE REAL MEASURE OF LONG-TERM

THE MAINTENANCE TEST AS THE REAL MEASURE OF LONG-TERM

SUMMIT PLEDGE, MEMORANDUM SIGNATURE OR LAUNCH CEREMONY

CONSTRUCTION OR ENROLMENT

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VERDICT → only the last two steps evidence a long-term institutional partnership

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

• ANNOUNCEMENT → summit pledge, memorandum signature or launch ceremony

• CONSTRUCTION or ENROLMENT: the visible first-year output

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

• STAFFING, FUNDING and TECHNICAL SUPPORT after the launch

• CONTINUED USE by the partner institution and its own students or patients

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

• VERDICT → only the last two steps evidence a long-term institutional partnership

• CONSEQUENCE → answer-writing must cite continuity, not the size of the pledge

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → only the last two steps evidence a long-term institutional partnership.

08

STAGE 08

SECURITY LIMB WITH ITS EXACT LIMITS

SECURITY LIMB WITH ITS EXACT LIMITS

FEBRUARY 2020, LUCKNOW

FIRST INDIA-AFRICA DEFENCE MINISTERS CONCLAVE

LUCKNOW DECLARATION ADOPTED

OCTOBER 2022, GANDHINAGAR

SECOND INDIA-AFRICA DEFENCE DIALOGUE; DECLARATION ON DEFENCE AND SECURITY

AFRICA-INDIA FIELD TRAINING EXERCISE, HELD IN INDIA IN 2019

ANTI-PIRACY DEPLOYMENTS AND CAPACITY COOPERATION, WESTERN INDIAN OCEAN AND

LUCKNOW Declaration adopted

FEBRUARY 2020, LUCKNOW → first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave

OCTOBER 2022, GANDHINAGAR → second India-Africa Defence Dialogue; declaration on defence and security cooperation

AFINDEX → Africa-India Field Training Exercise, held in India in 2019 and March 2023

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

• FEBRUARY 2020, LUCKNOW → first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave

• Lucknow Declaration adopted

• OCTOBER 2022, GANDHINAGAR → second India-Africa Defence Dialogue; declaration on defence and security cooperation

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

• AFINDEX → Africa-India Field Training Exercise, held in India in 2019 and March 2023

• MARITIME → anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation, western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden

• LIMIT → declarations and offers are not operational capability transfer

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

• LIMIT → episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance.

09

STAGE 09

ONE DELIVERED REPRESENTATION OUTCOME, PRICED CORRECTLY

ONE DELIVERED REPRESENTATION OUTCOME, PRICED CORRECTLY

9 SEPTEMBER 2023, NEW DELHI SUMMIT

THE AFRICAN UNION BECOMES A PERMANENT MEMBER OF THE

WHY IT MATTERS

PARTNERSHIP LANGUAGE CONVERTED INTO AN INSTITUTIONAL RESULT

REAL SCALE

ONE FORUM, ONE SEAT

NOT RESOLVED

ACTOR / INTEREST	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT
9 SEPTEMBER 2023, NEW DELHI SUMMIT → the African Union becomes a permanent member of the Group of Twenty	REAL SCALE → one forum, one seat	USE → cite as the benchmark for what a realistic representation success looks like
WHY IT MATTERS → partnership language converted into an institutional result	NOT RESOLVED → Africa's financing deficit, implementation deficit and United Nations representation deficit remain open	CLOSE DISTINCTION: Africa is not a single actor, African Union membership is not the same...

ACTOR / INTEREST

• 9 SEPTEMBER 2023, NEW DELHI SUMMIT → the African Union becomes a permanent member of the Group of Twenty

• WHY IT MATTERS → partnership language converted into an institutional result

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

• REAL SCALE → one forum, one seat

• NOT RESOLVED → Africa's financing deficit, implementation deficit and United Nations representation deficit remain open

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

• USE → cite as the benchmark for what a realistic representation success looks like

• CLOSE DISTINCTION: Africa is not a single actor, African Union membership is not the same...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WHY IT MATTERS → partnership language converted into an institutional result.

10

STAGE 10

POLITICAL RISK AND THE COMPARATOR, WITHOUT CARICATURE

POLITICAL RISK AND THE COMPARATOR, WITHOUT CARICATURE

SAHEL AND WEST AFRICA

COUPS IN MALI, GUINEA, BURKINA FASO AND NIGER, 2020-2023

PROJECT DELAY, HIGHER COMMERCIAL RISK, HARDER PARTNER SELECTION

ROUTED OBJECTIVE DEMANDS

2023 PRELIMS QUESTION 98; 2024 PRELIMS QUESTION 91

COMPETING ROUTE

CHINA'S FORUM ON CHINA-AFRICA COOPERATION AND INFRASTRUCTURE FINANCE

ACTOR / INTEREST	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT
SAHEL AND WEST AFRICA → coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger, 2020-2023	COMPETING ROUTE → China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and infrastructure finance	DISCIPLINE → do not assume African states passively choose between India and China
EFFECT: project delay, higher commercial risk, harder partner selection	INDIA'S COMPARATIVE EDGE → training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure, demand-driven project	EVIDENCE LIMIT: STATUS / LEVELS / IMPLEMENTATION: Name the country, African or regional...

WHY IT MATTERS → partnership language converted into an institutional result

NOT RESOLVED → Africa's financing deficit, implementation deficit and United Nations representation deficit remain open

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Africa is not a single actor, African Union membership is not the same...

ACTOR / INTEREST

- 9 SEPTEMBER 2023, NEW DELHI SUMMIT → the African Union becomes a permanent member of the Group of Twenty
- WHY IT MATTERS → partnership language converted into an institutional result

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- REAL SCALE → one forum, one seat
- NOT RESOLVED → Africa's financing deficit, implementation deficit and United Nations representation deficit remain open

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

- USE → cite as the benchmark for what a realistic representation success looks like
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Africa is not a single actor, African Union membership is not the same...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WHY IT MATTERS → partnership language converted into an institutional result.

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STAGE 10

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ROUTED OBJECTIVE DEMANDS

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COMPETING ROUTE

CHINA'S FORUM ON CHINA-AFRICA COOPERATION AND INFRASTRUCTURE FINANCE

ACTOR / INTEREST

SAHEL AND WEST AFRICA → coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger, 2020-2023

EFFECT: project delay, higher commercial risk, harder partner selection

ROUTED OBJECTIVE DEMANDS: 2023 Prelims question 98; 2024 Prelims question 91

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

COMPETING ROUTE → China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and infrastructure finance

INDIA'S COMPARATIVE EDGE → training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure, demand-driven selection

DISCIPLINE → do not generalise instability to the continent

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

DISCIPLINE → do not assume African states passively choose between India and China

EVIDENCE LIMIT: STATUS / LEVELS / IMPLEMENTATION: Name the country, African or regional...

ACTOR / INTEREST

- SAHEL AND WEST AFRICA → coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger, 2020-2023
- EFFECT: project delay, higher commercial risk, harder partner selection
- ROUTED OBJECTIVE DEMANDS: 2023 Prelims question 98; 2024 Prelims question 91

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- COMPETING ROUTE → China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and infrastructure finance
- INDIA'S COMPARATIVE EDGE → training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure, demand-driven project selection
- DISCIPLINE → do not generalise instability to the continent

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

- DISCIPLINE → do not assume African states passively choose between India and China
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: STATUS / LEVELS / IMPLEMENTATION: Name the country, African or regional...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: STATUS / LEVELS / IMPLEMENTATION: Name the country, African or regional.

11

STAGE 11

ANSWER SPINE TESTED AGAINST AFRICA'S OWN PLAN

ANSWER SPINE TESTED AGAINST AFRICA'S OWN PLAN

NAME THE PARTNERSHIP'S TWO LIMBS AND THE DATED SUMMIT

CAPACITY BUILDING, JOINT INSTITUTIONS, DIGITAL SUCCESSION, ONE DATED MEMORANDUM

COMMITMENT AGAINST DISBURSEMENT, ANNOUNCEMENT AGAINST FUNCTIONING INSTITUTION

SET THE MODEL AGAINST AGENDA 2063, SIGNED AS THE

DECLARATION IN MAY 2013, WITH ITS 2013 TO 2063

GRADED VERDICT ON DELIVERY AND LOCAL OWNERSHIP; PREDICT NO

OPEN → name the partnership's two limbs and the dated summit framework with its gap

BUILD → capacity building, joint institutions, digital succession, one dated memorandum

TEST → commitment against disbursement, announcement against functioning institution

ALIGN → set the model against Agenda 2063, signed as the 50th Anniversary Solemn

Declaration in May 2013, with its 2013 to 2063 horizon and ten-year implementation

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

- OPEN → name the partnership's two limbs and the dated summit framework with its gap
- BUILD → capacity building, joint institutions, digital succession, one dated memorandum
- TEST → commitment against disbursement, announcement against functioning institution

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

- ALIGN → set the model against Agenda 2063, signed as the 50th Anniversary Solemn
- Declaration in May 2013, with its 2013 to 2063 horizon and ten-year implementation
- plans, and its Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

- CLOSE → graded verdict on delivery and local ownership; predict no summit or project

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → graded verdict on delivery and local ownership; predict no summit or project.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

NINETEEN JOINT INSTITUTIONS

THE CORE INSTITUTIONAL ARCHITECTURE

PAN AFRICAN E-NETWORK

HISTORICAL TELE-EDUCATION-CENTRED PRECURSOR

SUCCESSOR TELE-EDUCATION AND TELE-MEDICINE NETWORK (MEA-TCIL)

INDIA-SADC MEMORANDUM OF UNDERSTANDING ON ECONOMIC COOPERATION (2 JULY)

QUANTITATIVE BACKDROP (MEA AFRICA BRIEF, APRIL 2026)

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE AND INSTRUMENT DEPTH

- Nineteen joint institutions: the core institutional architecture,
- Pan African e-Network: historical tele-education-centred precursor
- e-VBAB: successor tele-education and tele-medicine network (MEA-TCIL
- India-SADC Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation (2 July

STATUS, DATE AND FIGURE LIMIT

- Quantitative backdrop (MEA Africa brief, April 2026): more than 190
- CAUTION: ITEC (Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme): per the
- CAUTION: India-Africa Forum Summit (IAFS): the umbrella political mechanism —
- Direct PYQ boundary case (2025 Q9): the question's own framing —

COMPARATIVE DIPLOMATIC NUANCE

- CAUTION: Boundary case — digital-partnership scale claims: an advanced answer
- CAUTION: Boundary case — ITEC's dual role: ITEC serves both a general technical
- CAUTION: Boundary case — African agency in setting priorities: the model's
- CAUTION: Announcement-to-delivery gap: grant announcements (\$500 million) and

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.